

down. The overall foodgrain output for 2009-10 is likely to drop by about 40 lakh tonnes from last year's high of 204 lakh tonnes due to severe drought and floods in parts of the state.

Rosaiah has, therefore, wisely ruled out the possibility of implementing, for now, two important election promises made by YSR—enhancing the rice quota to the poor from 20 to 30 kg a month and increasing free power supply to farmers from seven to nine hours. "There is cutback of 35,000 tonnes in what the Central Government gives us and we need another 1,75,000 tonnes to increase the monthly quota by 10 kg.

poses to take up development programmes as it has no money in the treasury except for the payment of salaries," says Naidu.

While the Government grapples with the paucity of funds, flagship schemes are likely to flounder and dent the popularity of the Congress. Cutbacks in Jalayaganam imply Rosaiah is not going to enjoy the support of the farming community in many parched tracts and that of the contractors for irrigation projects. Pruning of the welfare

some of those overlooked contest in vain the new appointments in court. In recent weeks, he has initiated a district by district review of development initiatives and even travels to launch and commission projects. He has also directed district collectors to submit action taken reports on the issues raised by public representatives at the district review committee meetings.

In spite of this, Rosaiah is hamstrung by his style. "He is best taking an adversarial approach with sound logic and meaningful reasoning but is wanting in the emotive appeal expected from a people's leader," says



**THE JAGAN MOHAN REDDY CAMP HAS KEPT THE CONGRESS AND ROSAIAH UNDER PRESSURE**

**Jagan Mohan Reddy remains a formidable foe for Chief Minister Rosaiah.**

Unless the Central Government gives us more and we weed out bogus claimants, the cost of running the public distribution system will balloon in the state," explains Rosaiah. "A similar wide demand-supply gap prevents us from providing nine hours of free power to the farm sector."

Telugu Desam Party chief N. Chandrababu Naidu contends the state Budget is not sustainable and is as confusing as the political situation in the state. "The chief minister lacks clarity on how the Government pro-

measures means annoying legislators who will find it difficult to face angry voters. Longer power outages are also scaring away industry. Rosaiah is certain that there is no easy way out. "I wish I had a magic wand to pull the state out of the financial crunch," says Rosaiah. Seemingly soft, he does exercise a mind of his own like in making changes in bureaucracy. In both the choice of S.V. Prasad as chief secretary and R.R. Girish Kumar as director-general of police, he glossed over the seniority rule that made

political commentator C. Narasimha Rao. But that is if the Congress needs one who can rally supporters on priority in Andhra Pradesh. At the moment, there is no such need. The party finds that resolute speaking in a reassuring tone can fetch richer political dividends as peace and harmony is restored in the troubled state.

Rosaiah, who once confessed that he did not imagine becoming chief minister, has little to lose and the Congress much to gain from his genre of governance. ■